

The background of the slide features a close-up photograph of vibrant green leafy vegetables, likely lettuce, which is visible in the top-left and bottom-right corners, framing the central text area.

Green Together: Sustainable Agriculture for Marginalized Communities

PROJECT JOURNEY:

The journey of Green Together was fueled by creativity, collaboration, and determination. From the beginning, I focused on connecting with organizations that share similar values around sustainability and youth empowerment. Through meaningful partnerships with groups like Cangro Agrifoods Inc., Future S.E.T., and the Nigerian Canadian Organization of Windsor, I was able to strengthen the project's impact and extend its reach within the community.



PROJECT JOURNEY:

The Green Together project offered an engaging, hands-on learning experience rooted in both innovation and cultural relevance. Participants explored sustainable indoor farming methods, such as hydroponics and container gardening, while also learning about traditional agricultural practices from various cultures, including African, Asian, Caribbean, and Latinx foodways. The workshops focused on growing culturally significant crops like amaranth (callaloo), jute leaves (ewedu), and okra, reflecting the heritage and diets of many participants.

With a hybrid model that blended in-person and virtual delivery, the program welcomed 33 participants from diverse backgrounds. This format ensured accessibility while creating a space where agricultural education could honour both modern technology and ancestral knowledge, empowering participants to grow food that feels familiar, nourishing, and culturally affirming—right from their homes.



PROJECT JOURNEY:

The project also offered a rich mix of interactive activities designed to inspire curiosity, confidence, and connection. Participants engaged in culturally rooted agri-tech discussions led by diverse mentors, including Black and newcomer youth professionals in the field. These sessions spotlighted real career paths and lived experiences in sustainable agriculture. One of the most impactful elements was the hands-on building of DIY hydroponic systems using recycled household items, an exercise that combined sustainability, creativity, and accessibility.



PROJECT JOURNEY:

Participants engaged deeply with sustainable agriculture by growing culturally significant crops, such as jute leaves (also known as Ewedu or Molokhia), using coco coir, an eco-friendly alternative to soil. This approach not only introduced youth to innovative indoor growing techniques but also reinforced connections to cultural food practices often left out of mainstream agricultural education.

These hands-on experiences were supported by interactive sessions on agri-tech trends and emerging career opportunities, helping youth see themselves as future leaders in food technology, climate action, and culturally rooted sustainability.



IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Participants shared how the program opened their eyes to agriculture technology, with 90% of surveyed youth reporting it was their first time learning about hydroponics. During hands-on workshops, they built mini systems and grew culturally familiar crops like jute leaves, prompting reflections on how farming connects to identity and food security.

Several youth asked for copies of the agri-tech career slides and data I presented, one participant said, “I didn’t know you could use science like this to grow food without soil. It makes me want to study more.” This feedback affirmed the impact: the project didn’t just teach techniques, it sparked long-term interest in a field they never knew they belonged in.



AREAS FOR IMPROVEMENT AND REFLECTION

Reflecting on Green Together, I see clear areas where I can sharpen my impact. Improving communication, refining outreach to reach even more youth, and identifying sustainable funding models will strengthen future initiatives. While I faced logistical and resource-related challenges, these experiences helped build my adaptability and sharpened my problem-solving approach. Moving forward, I'm committed to using these lessons to deepen the project's reach and resilience.



CLOSING REMARKS

Green Together showed how culturally grounded, hands-on education in sustainable agriculture can empower youth to see themselves as innovators in the fight for food security. As the sole creator and facilitator, I designed this project to introduce participants to accessible techniques like hydroponics and to center crops and practices that reflected their identities and traditions. This allowed participants to connect with the material on a deeper level and see agriculture as a viable, meaningful path.

The impact was clear, participants left not only with skills but with confidence, curiosity, and a sense of purpose. Their excitement confirmed that this work is far from finished. I hope to continue Green Together as a growing platform for culturally relevant agri-tech training, expanding its reach and creating long-term solutions for food security through education, empowerment, and innovation.



ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to thank GLOCAL for giving me the opportunity to pursue this project and receive this microgrant. I hope to continue driving this type of change in the future and build upon this project to reach a wider range of communities.

